



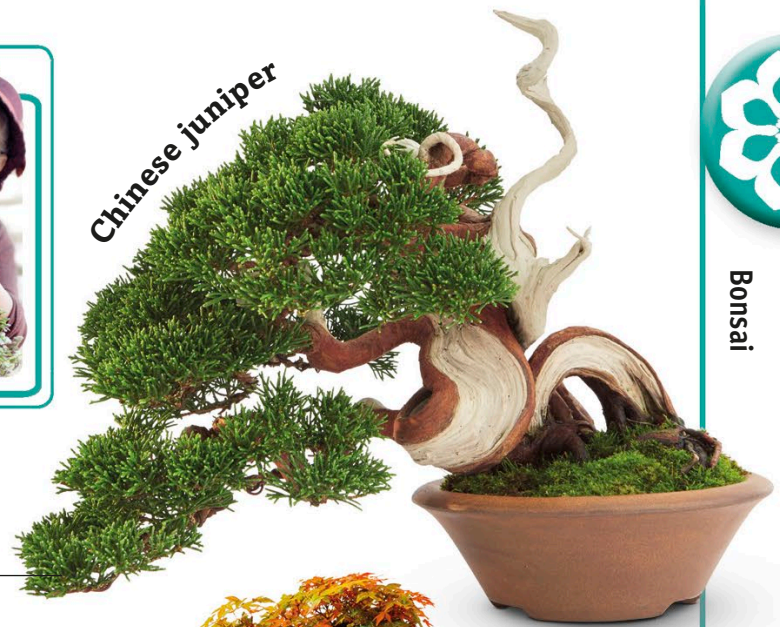
PRUNING A BONSAI

Special scissors are used to trim bonsai branches in order to make an attractive tree shape, while preventing the trees from growing too quickly.



Dramatic shapes are created by pruning or twisting branches around wires, which are later removed.

Chinese juniper



Fall leaves make a colorful display popular with bonsai enthusiasts.



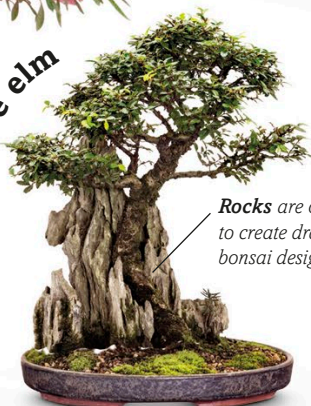
Japanese maple

Pink, white, red, or purple blossoms usually bloom in May, which is called "satsuki" in Japanese—giving this tree its name.



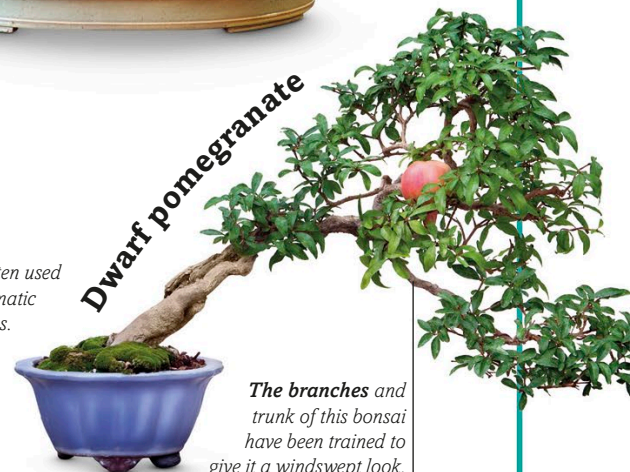
Chinese elm

Rocks are often used to create dramatic bonsai designs.



Dwarf pomegranate

The branches and trunk of this bonsai have been trained to give it a windswept look.



requires careful pruning of the shoots and roots, and it takes skill not to kill the trees in the process. The **Chinese elm** bonsai is more likely to survive mistakes made by beginners. One **Chinese juniper** in Japan has been proven to be about 1,000 years

old, with centuries of careful pruning and shaping by bonsai masters. With enough time and care, a bonsai tree can become extremely valuable. The most expensive bonsai ever sold was in 2011. It had a price tag of 100,000,000 Japanese yen, equivalent to around \$1.3 million (£840,000).

